

[ENTER COMPANY NAME]

QUALITY MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

Document and Data Control

Document Identifier	SOP-QA-001
Current Version / Revision	00
Effective Date	[Date of Final Approval]
Review Cycle	Annual (Every 12 Months)
Applicable Regulatory Standards	ISO 13485:2016 Clause 4.2.4 & 4.2.5 FDA 21 CFR Part 820.40 EU MDR 2017/745 Annex IX

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Date: _____	Date: _____	Date: _____

1.0 Purpose

This Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) defines the mandatory requirements and rigorous framework for the creation, review, approval, distribution, revision, obsolescence, and archiving of Quality Management System (QMS) documentation and control data. The principal objective of this procedure is to ensure that only current, approved, and accurate documents are available across all operational areas, thereby preventing the inadvertent use of obsolete or unverified information in the manufacture, testing, distribution, and clinical use of medical devices.

2.0 Scope

This SOP is universally applicable to all documents and data configurations supporting or defining the QMS governing medical device design, manufacturing, regulatory compliance, and commercialization. Controlled documents governed by this SOP explicitly include, but are not limited to:

- Quality Manual, Quality Policies, and Corporate Objectives.
- Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) and Work Instructions (WIs).
- Device Master Records (DMR), Device History Documents, and Design History Files (DHF).
- Material Specifications, Engineering Drawings, Component Blueprints, and Bill of Materials (BOM).
- Quality Records, Inspection Procedures, Verification/Validation Protocols, and Reports.
- Software Source Code, Configuration Files, and Automated Test Scripts.
- External Standards (ISO, IEC, ASTM) and Regulatory Master Files.

3.0 Responsibility and Authority

3.1 Document Control Officer (DCO) / QA Administrator

The DCO possesses primary organizational authority to administer the document control system. Responsibilities include assigning control identifiers, maintaining the Master Document Index, managing electronic access controls, tracking routing matrix timelines, formatting documents to template structures, and ensuring the absolute withdrawal of obsolete items from circulation.

3.2 Authors / Technical Originators

Authors are responsible for drafting new or revising existing documents in strict accordance with corporate styles. Originators ensure structural content is technically accurate, precise, aligned with actual field practices, and cross-referenced with related workflows.

3.3 Technical and Regulatory Reviewers

Designated department heads and Regulatory Specialists are responsible for reviewing proposed documentation for operational feasibility, inter-departmental compatibility, compliance with prevailing global regulations (e.g., ISO 13485, 21 CFR 820), and safety implications.

3.4 Executive Management / Final Approvers

The Head of Quality Assurance (or designee) holds definitive signature authority to transition documents into an operational "Effective" state, certifying that the document meets all procedural and compliance thresholds.

4.0 Procedure

4.1 Document Generation and Formatting Standards

All controlled documents must be drafted utilizing standardized software templates to preserve visual and structural consistency. Every document must formally include a consistent header and footer block detailing the document ID, Revision level, Title, and actual Page numbering structured as "Page X of Y". Font choices must remain standardized (Arial or Helvetica, minimum 10pt for running text) to guarantee legibility over prolonged archive cycles.

CRITICAL COMPLIANCE NOTE: Handwritten annotations or field modifications onto active SOPs are strictly prohibited. Any modification to text requires formal processing through the established change control pipeline.

4.2 Document Identification and Numbering Metrics

A standardized alphanumeric sequencing matrix shall be utilized for absolute identification. Identifiers follow the structured syntax: SOP-[Department]-[Three-Digit Sequential Number].

Department Prefix	Functional Area	Example Document Mapping
QA	Quality Assurance	SOP-QA-001 (Document Control)
RA	Regulatory Affairs	SOP-RA-012 (Vigilance Reporting)
RD	Research & Development	SOP-RD-005 (Design Controls)
MF	Manufacturing Operations	WI-MF-088 (Cleanroom Assembly)

4.3 Review and Approval Process Flow

Prior to formal release, all draft documents must systematically pass through a multi-stage workflow. This process is structured as follows:

Step 1: Drafting & Verification

The Originator compiles the technical content using the correct template and executes an initial accuracy assessment against actual manufacturing or testing parameters.

Step 2: Cross-Functional Review

The draft is routed via the Electronic Document Management System (EDMS) to impacted stakeholders. For example, a manufacturing SOP must be reviewed by Engineering, Production, and Quality Assurance to catch operational conflicts.

Step 3: Formal Approval

Once reviews are cleared, the document moves to the final approval phase. Approvals must be documented either via hand-signed signatures or standard 21 CFR Part 11 compliant electronic signatures.

4.4 Release, Training, and Implementation

Approved documents cannot be transitioned to an active status immediately. A defined implementation buffer (typically 5 to 10 business days) must be observed to coordinate mandatory training activities. The Training Coordinator must verify that all personnel assigned to tasks affected by the document have successfully completed training assessment records before the Document Control Officer executes the systemic deployment.

4.5 Control of Obsolete Documents

Upon the release of an updated document revision, the Document Control Officer must immediately update the Master Document Index and revoke general read-only access to the previous version within the EDMS. For legacy physical copies located at assembly cleanrooms or lab benches, the DCO must physically retrieve the prints and stamp them conspicuously in red ink with the words "OBSOLETE DOCUMENT - DO NOT USE". One master archive copy of the obsolete version is retained securely in physical or electronic fire-walled archives for regulatory tracing purposes.

5.0 Document Retention and Archival

Quality records and historical document revisions must be maintained securely to ensure continuous accessibility during regulatory audits. In accordance with ISO 13485 and FDA guidelines, documents must be securely archived for a duration equal to the lifetime of the medical device as defined by the corporate technical files, but absolutely no less than a minimum of five (5) years from the formal commercial release of the last unit manufactured under that specific design profile.

6.0 Associated Reference Materials

- **SOP-QA-002:** Change Control System
- **SOP-QA-015:** Training and Competency Management
- **Form-QA-001A:** Document Creation / Modification Request Form

• **Form-QA-001B:** Master Document Index Log

7.0 Revision History Log

Revision Level	Effective Date	Author / Originator	Detailed Description of Modifications
00	[Date]	[Name], QA	Initial baseline release of formalized Document and Data Control Standard Operating Procedure for global QMS harmonization.